FREE GUIDE · AI CAREERS

5 skills that keep engineers hired

On Naukri, AI and ML hiring is up 25% in a year while IT services hiring is down 3%. None of these 5 skills is "just prompting": companies want engineers who can ship and run AI.

1. **Querying data**
2. **Building on LLMs**
3. **LLMOps**
4. **Workflow automation**
5. **Cloud + security for AI**

★ The plan

One skill every 2 weeks. Build one project that uses all five and put it on GitHub. That project is your portfolio.

THE ROADMAP

Skills 1–3: build with AI

1 Querying data

SQL is still the fastest way to answer business questions, and LinkedIn lists querying as India's fastest-growing engineering skill.

- Week 1: SELECT, WHERE, GROUP BY, JOINs
- Week 2: window functions and CTEs
- Project: analyse a public dataset and publish the queries

2 Building on LLMs

Calling a model is easy; building something reliable on top of it is the skill.

- Call an LLM API and stream the answer
- Build RAG over your own documents
- Add an agent with 2-3 tools, then write evals to test it

3 LLMOps

Running AI in production: knowing what it did, what it cost and whether it still works.

- Deploy your app; add logging and tracing
- Track cost and latency per request
- Version your prompts and run evals on every change

THE ROADMAP

Skills 4–5: make it useful and safe

4 Workflow automation

AI that does real work: tickets, reports, reviews, follow-ups.

- Pick one boring task you do every week
- Automate it end to end (n8n, scripts or an agent)
- Measure the hours saved; that number goes on your CV

5 Cloud + security for AI

Every agent needs an identity, secrets and limits. Few engineers know this well.

- IAM and least privilege on one cloud
- Secrets management and short-lived credentials
- Network basics: private endpoints, egress rules

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AI system design, cloud and security, explained by an engineer. Comment DESIGN on any AI System Design reel for the free cheat sheet.